HISTORY • RAS PRELIMS NOTES

Rajasthan Art, Culture & Heritage

Forts, temples, paintings, handicrafts, folk dances & music, dialects, saints, folk deities, fairs, attire and ornaments

Inside these notes

- Fort, dance, deity and ornament tables for match-the-pair questions
- Painting schools and craft centres in one master grid
- Memory hooks and exam traps in every chapter

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Notes made for RAS aspirants - simple language, connected concepts, PYQ-based facts.

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How to use: read a chapter fully once, then revise only the tables, MEMORY HOOKS and EXAM TRAPS. Every fact here is written the way RAS papers ask it.

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StuDy

1. Forts and Palaces of Rajasthan

Why Rajasthan is the land of forts

- Rajasthan has more great forts than any other Indian state. Its rulers built forts on Aravalli hilltops, in the middle of lakes, on flat desert land and even inside river bends. The RAS paper tests this chapter mostly as **match-the-pair**: which fort is in which district, who built it, and what each fort is famous for.
- Traditional Indian texts divide forts into types, and Rajasthan has every one of them:

- **Giri durg** — a hill fort (Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Mehrangarh). - **Jal durg** — a water fort, protected by a river or lake (Gagron, surrounded by rivers). - **Maru / Dhanvan durg** — a desert fort, protected by sand and distance (Jaisalmer). - **Sthal durg** — a fort on plain land, protected by walls and moats (Lohagarh of Bharatpur).

MEMORY HOOK: Remember the four shields — **hill, water, desert, land**. Whichever shield a fort uses tells you its type instantly.

The six UNESCO Hill Forts of Rajasthan

- In **2013**, six Rajasthan forts were together inscribed on the **UNESCO World Heritage List** as the "Hill Forts of Rajasthan". This exact list is a favourite RAS question.

UNESCO Hill Fort	District / Place	Builder / Period	Signature fact
Chittorgarh	Chittorgarh	Tradition: Chitrangada Mori; later Guhil-Sisodia capital	Largest fort of India by area; three famous **sakas**
Kumbhalgarh	Rajsamand	**Rana Kumbha** (15th century), architect **Mandan**	Great wall of about **36 km**; birthplace of **Maharana Pratap**
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	Chauhan rulers (traditionally 944 CE)	Falls to **Alauddin Khilji in 1301**, taken from Hammir Dev Chauhan
Jaisalmer (Sonar Fort)	Jaisalmer	**Rawal Jaisal**, 1156 CE	Golden sandstone fort on Trikuta hill; a **living fort** — people still reside inside
Amber	Jaipur	**Raja Man Singh I** (begun 1592)	Sheesh Mahal and Ganesh Pol; old capital of the Kachhwahas
Gagron	Jhalawar	Dod Rajputs (traditionally Bijaldev, 12th century)	The great **jal durg** — ringed by the Ahu and Kali Sindh rivers

Chittorgarh — the fort of honour

- The fort stands on a long hill above the **Berach river**. Its table-top plateau carries palaces, towers and temples.
- **Vijay Stambh (Tower of Victory)** — built by **Rana Kumbha in 1448** to celebrate his victory over **Mahmud Khilji of Malwa**; nine storeys high.
- **Kirti Stambh (Tower of Fame)** — older than Vijay Stambh; built in the 12th century by the Jain merchant **Jijaji Rathod**, dedicated to the first Jain Tirthankara **Adinath**; seven storeys.

- The fort saw **three sakas**: **1303** (Alauddin Khilji, in the time of Ratan Singh — the Padmini episode), **1535** (Bahadur Shah of Gujarat) and **1568** (Akbar).

EXAM TRAP: Vijay Stambh and Kirti Stambh get swapped in options. Fix the pair: **Vijay = Kumbha = victory over Malwa; Kirti = Jain merchant = Adinath**. And Kirti Stambh is the *earlier* tower, though Vijay Stambh is taller.

PYQ PATTERN: RAS repeatedly asks "Which fort did UNESCO include?" and "Who built the Vijay Stambh?" — both answered from the table above.

Kumbhalgarh — the great wall

- Built by **Rana Kumbha** in the 15th century; his court architect **Mandan** designed it. The fort's defensive wall runs about **36 km**, among the longest walls in the world — it is often called the **Great Wall of India**.
- **Maharana Pratap was born here in 1540.** The small citadel on the highest point is called **Katargarh**, the "eye of Mewar", from where the whole Aravalli line can be watched.
- The fort was considered nearly unconquerable — it changed hands only when drinking water inside ran out.

MEMORY HOOK: **Kumbha = Kumbhalgarh = 36 km wall + Pratap's birth**. One name answers four questions.

The other great forts

Fort	Place	Key fact
Mehrangarh	Jodhpur	Built by **Rao Jodha (1459)** on the Bhakurcheeria hill; among India's largest forts; thick walls still bear cannon marks
Taragarh	Ajmer	Chauhan fort of Ajayraj's line; called the **"Gibraltar of the East"**; also known as Garh Bithli
Taragarh	Bundi	Built by the Hada ruler **Rao Bar Singh (1354)**; famous for its huge water reservoirs and tunnel legends
Lohagarh	Bharatpur	The **"Iron Fort"** of Maharaja **Suraj Mal**; its mud-reinforced walls defeated repeated British attacks under Lord Lake (1805)
Bhatner	Hanumangarh	One of India's oldest forts, on the **Ghaggar river**; attacked by Mahmud Ghaznavi and Timur
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	Stands where the Aravalli meets the Vindhya ranges, inside today's tiger reserve

EXAM TRAP: There are **two Taragarhs** — Ajmer and Bundi. If the option says "Gibraltar of the East", it is **Ajmer**; if it says Hada rulers, it is **Bundi**.

Palaces, havelis and palace architecture

- **Havelis of Shekhawati** — the towns of **Nawalgarh, Mandawa and Fatehpur** are famous for the painted havelis of rich Marwari merchants. Their walls are covered with frescoes — gods, trains, motor cars and even aeroplanes painted side by side. Shekhawati is called an **open-air art gallery**.
- **Patwon ki Haveli (Jaisalmer)** — a cluster of five havelis built by the Jain merchant **Guman Chand Patwa** and his sons in the 19th century; the most famous haveli group of the desert city. **Salim Singh ki Haveli** (with its ship-shaped upper floor) and **Nathmal ki Haveli** are the other Jaisalmer landmarks.
- **City Palace, Jaipur** — built under **Sawai Jai Singh II**; its Chandra Mahal still houses the royal family, and the Govind Dev Ji temple stands inside the complex.
- **City Palace, Udaipur** — the largest palace complex of Rajasthan, rising on the eastern bank of Lake Pichola, begun by **Maharana Udai Singh II**.
- **Umaid Bhawan, Jodhpur** — a 20th-century palace built by **Maharaja Umaid Singh (1929–1943)** as famine-relief work; because it uses Chittar sandstone it is also called **Chittar Palace**. Part of it is still the royal residence, part a luxury hotel and museum.
- **Hawa Mahal (Jaipur, 1799)** — built by **Sawai Pratap Singh**; a five-storey facade with **953 small windows (jharokhas)** through which royal women watched street processions unseen.
- **Jal Mahal** — the water palace standing in **Man Sagar lake**, Jaipur.

PYQ PATTERN: Match-the-pair on havelis is common — **Patwon = Jaisalmer, painted havelis = Shekhawati, Umaid Bhawan = famine relief + Chittar stone**.

More forts to place on the map

Fort	District	Key fact
Junagarh	Bikaner	Built by **Raja Rai Singh (1589–94)** on flat land, never conquered; famous for its palaces and the **Anup Mahal**
Jaigarh	Jaipur	Fort above Amber, built to guard it; houses **Jaivana**, among the world's largest cannons on wheels
Nahargarh	Jaipur	Built by **Sawai Jai Singh II (1734)** on the Aravalli edge above the city
Ahichhatragarh (Nagaur Fort)	Nagaur	Ancient fort of the Naga rulers and later the Rathores; among India's best-restored forts
Bala Qila	Alwar	Hill fort associated with Hasan Khan Mewati; Babur stayed here a night in 1527
Jalore Fort	Jalore	Chauhan fort of the Songara line on the Songiri hill; withstood Alauddin Khilji in 1311–12 under Kanhaddev
Siwana Fort	Barmer side	Fort of the Parmars and Chauhans; also attacked by Alauddin Khilji (1308)
Shergarh (Dholpur)	Dholpur	Riverside fort rebuilt by Sher Shah Suri's line; gave Dholpur its old name Shergarh

Fort	District	Key fact
Neemrana	Kotputli-Behror side	15th-century Chauhan fort-palace, now a heritage hotel

- Notice the Alauddin pattern: he took **Chittorgarh (1303), Ranthambore (1301), Jalore (1311) and Siwana (1308)** — four fort questions hang on one invader's list.
- **Jaigarh–Amber–Nahargarh** form Jaipur's fort triangle; Jaigarh guards Amber from above and is linked to it by a passage.

MEMORY HOOK: For Bikaner, remember the odd one out — **Junagarh stands on flat land and was never taken**, in a state where every other great fort crowns a hill.

2. Temples and Man-made Water Bodies

Temple styles at a glance

- Most Rajasthan temples follow the **Nagara style** of north India — a curving shikhara (tower) over the sanctum. The marble Jain temples of **Dilwara** and the sandstone temples of **Osian** and **Kiradu** show regional Solanki and Gurjara-Pratihara variations.
- Rajasthan's temple questions are again mostly pairing: **temple × place × deity × one special fact**.

The famous temples

Temple	Place	Deity / Sect	Signature fact
Dilwara — Vimal Vasahi	Mount Abu, Sirohi	Adinath (1st Jain Tirthankara)	Built **1031 CE** by **Vimal Shah**, minister of the Solanki king Bhima I; unmatched white-marble carving
Dilwara — Luna Vasahi	Mount Abu	Neminath (22nd Tirthankara)	Built 1230 CE by the brothers **Vastupal and Tejpal**
Ranakpur (Chaumukha)	Pali district	Adinath	Built under **Rana Kumbha** by the merchant **Dharna Shah**, architect **Depa**; famous for its **1,444 pillars**
Eklingji	Near Udaipur (Kailashpuri)	Shiva	Clan deity (kuldevta) of the Mewar rulers; the Maharana ruled as Shiva's *diwan*
Jagdish Temple	Udaipur	Vishnu (Jagannath)	Built by **Maharana Jagat Singh I (1651)** at the City Palace gate
Shrinathji	Nathdwara, Rajsamand	Krishna (child form)	Idol brought from Govardhan in **1672** to escape Aurangzeb's iconoclasm; centre of the **Pushtimarg (Vallabh) sect**

Temple	Place	Deity / Sect	Signature fact
Govind Dev Ji	Jaipur	Krishna	Idol brought from Vrindavan by **Sawai Jai Singh II**; temple inside the City Palace complex
Brahma Temple	Pushkar, Ajmer	Brahma	One of the very few Brahma temples in the world; Pushkar lake and the Kartik fair are beside it
Karni Mata	Deshnok, Bikaner	Karni Mata (Charan goddess)	The famous **rat temple** — thousands of revered rats (*kabbas*) live in the temple
Osian temples	Osian, Jodhpur district	Hindu and Jain (Sachiya Mata)	Ancient temple town of the Gurjara-Pratihara age; called the **"Khajuraho of Rajasthan"**
Kiradu temples	Barmer district	Shiva group	Solanki-style temples in a deserted city, famed for fine sculpture

- **Eklingji and the Mewar idea of kingship**: the Maharanas of Mewar considered Eklingji (Shiva) the real ruler of Mewar and themselves only his ministers — a fact RAS links with the state's political culture.
- **Nathdwara** is also the home of **Pichhwai painting** (see Painting chapter), because Shrinathji's shrine needed painted cloth backdrops — temple and painting grew together.

MEMORY HOOK: Two pillar-numbers and marble stories settle most temple questions: **Ranakpur = 1,444 pillars; Dilwara = 1031 CE + Vimal Shah**. Pushkar answers itself — the only Brahma temple town.

EXAM TRAP: **Deshnok (Karni Mata) is in Bikaner district, Nathdwara is in Rajsamand district** — examiners swap these districts. Also note **Vimal Shah was a minister, not a king**.

Stepwells — Rajasthan's underground palaces

- In a dry land, the stepwell (**baori / bawdi**) was both a water store and a cool public hall. Three names must be fixed:

- **Chand Baori, Abhaneri (Dausa district)** — built in the **9th century** by **King Chanda** of the Nikumbha dynasty. With about **3,500 narrow steps in 13 levels**, it is among the deepest and largest stepwells of India. - **Raniji ki Baori, Bundi** — built in **1699 by Rani Nathavati**, queen of Rao Raja Anirudh Singh. Bundi is called the **city of stepwells (Baorinagar)**. - **Panna Meena ka Kund, Jaipur** (near Amber) — a symmetrical eight-level stepwell of criss-cross stairs, popular for its perfect geometry.

PYQ PATTERN: "Chand Baori is located at — Abhaneri" and "Raniji ki Baori was built by — Rani Nathavati" are direct one-liners asked in this exact form.

The great lakes — water heritage

Lake	City / District	Key fact
Pichola	Udaipur	Said to be made in the 14th century in Rana Lakha's time; carries the island palaces **Jag Niwas (Lake Palace)** and **Jag Mandir**
Jaisamand (Dhebar Lake)	Udaipur district	Built by **Maharana Jai Singh (1685–91)** on the Gomati river; among the largest artificial lakes of Asia in its time
Rajsamand	Rajsamand	Built by **Maharana Raj Singh I**; its northern embankment, the **Nauchowki**, carries the **Raj Prashasti**, one of the longest Sanskrit inscriptions, on 25 marble slabs
Fateh Sagar	Udaipur	Linked to Pichola; rebuilt by Maharana Fateh Singh after the old dam was washed away
Pushkar Lake	Ajmer district	Sacred lake ringed by 52 ghats; Kartik Purnima bathing
Nakki Lake	Mount Abu, Sirohi	Sacred hill lake; tradition says it was dug out by the nails (*nakh*) of the gods
Ana Sagar	Ajmer	12th-century lake of the Chauhan king **Arnoraj (Anaji)**; Mughal pavilions (baradaris) on its bank
Sambhar Lake	Jaipur–Nagaur side	India's largest inland **salt lake**; salt production since ancient times

MEMORY HOOK: Udaipur's lakes run in a chain — **Pichola – Fateh Sagar – Jaisamand**, and the inscription lake is **Rajsamand (Nauchowki = nine pavilions)**. The name *Nauchowki* itself is the memory hook: *nau* = nine chaukis on the dam.

More temples that carry one mark each

- **Khatu Shyam Ji (Sikar)** — Krishna worshipped as the head of the Mahabharata warrior Barbarik; one of Rajasthan's most-visited modern pilgrim centres, with a great Phalgun fair.
- **Salasar Balaji (Churu)** — Hanuman temple of the Shekhawati belt, founded after an idol was found by a farmer in the 18th century tradition.
- **Tanot Mata (Jaisalmer)** — goddess temple near the Pakistan border, kept famous by the Border Security Force; unexploded bombs of the 1971 war are preserved in its museum.
- **Ambika Mata, Jagat (Udaipur side)** — a finely carved 10th-century Devi temple, called the **"Khajuraho of Mewar"**.
- **Arthuna (Banswara)** — ruined temple town of the Vagad Parmars with Shaiv and Jain shrines.
- **Tripura Sundari (Banswara)** — ancient Shaktipeeth of the Vagad region near Talwara.
- **Galtaji (Jaipur)** — temple valley in the Aravallis with sacred water tanks (kunds) and a famous monkey population; linked with the Ramanandi seat (see Saints chapter).
- **Sheetla Mata, Chaksu (Jaipur side)** — the goddess of smallpox-era healing, worshipped on **Sheetlashtami (Basoda)**.

More water bodies

- **Gadsisar Lake (Jaisalmer)** — a 14th-century rainwater tank ringed by temples and chhatris, built in the time of Rawal Gadsi; the artist-prostitute **Tilon** built its famous gateway, Tilon ki Prol.
- **Balsamand Lake (Jodhpur)** — an artificial lake of the 12th century with a later summer palace on its bank.
- **Siliserh Lake (Alwar)** — hill-ringed lake with a royal hunting lodge, a tourist landmark of the Aravalli east.
- **Udai Sagar (Udaipur)** — built by Maharana Udai Singh II as one of the city's eastern reservoirs.

EXAM TRAP: Gadsisar is a tank (water heritage), not a fort — and its gateway story belongs to Tilon, a courtesan, not to any king. Jaipur also has a Sheetla Mata story tied to Chaksu, which examiners pair against Deshnok's Karni Mata — keep district labels attached to every goddess.

3. Painting Schools of Rajasthan

How to study this chapter

- Rajasthani miniature painting grew in the royal courts. Every school is asked with the **same four facts**: its **centre, golden period/patron, signature subject, and one famous painter or painting**. Learn the master table first; the notes under it only explain the traps.

School	Centre	Golden age / Patron	Signature features	Painter / Famous work
Mewar	Udaipur, Chawand, Nathdwara	17th century; Amar Singh I, Jagat Singh I	Bold primary colours, flat composition, Ragamala and Ramayana series	**Nisaruddin** (Ragamala set, 1605, at Chawand); **Sahibdin** (Bhagavata Purana, Rasikpriya)
Nathdwara (Pichhwai)	Nathdwara	After Shrinathji's arrival, 1672 onwards	Large devotional cloth paintings of Krishna hung behind the idol	Pichhwai panels for the Shrinathji temple festivals
Marwar	Jodhpur	Maharaja Man Singh's reign	Ramayana and Dhola-Maru scenes, desert settings, strong local flavour	Court ateliers of Jodhpur
Bundi	Bundi	Rao Chhatrasal and Rao Bhao Singh (17th century)	Lush green nature, water, peacocks, lovers on terraces; Ragamala scenes	The **Chitrashala** of Bundi palace
Kota	Kota	Maharao **Ram Singh II** (19th century)	Dense forests and **royal hunting (shikar) scenes**; women shown hunting	Hunting rolls of the Kota court atelier
Kishangarh	Kishangarh	**Savant Singh** (18th century)	Elongated lotus-petal eyes, sharp chin, serene Radha-Krishna themes	**Nihal Chand** — painter of **Bani Thani**

School	Centre	Golden age / Patron	Signature features	Painter / Famous work
Jaipur	Jaipur	Sawai Pratap Singh	Refined **portraits**, often large; Mughal influence softened locally	**Sahib Ram**, master portraitist
Alwar	Alwar	Bakhtawar Singh, Vinay Singh	Portraiture and painting on ivory; strong Mughal and Company-style touch	Alwar court atelier
Bikaner	Bikaner	Maharaja Anup Singh	Fine Mughal-Deccan finish brought by artists returning from the Deccan; linked with **Usta art**	**Ruknuddin**, leading court painter

The facts that carry marks

- **Mewar is the oldest school.** Its first dated landmark is the **Ragamala series of 1605**, painted by **Nisaruddin** at **Chawand** (the wartime capital of Mewar after Chittorgarh's fall). Under **Sahibdin**, Mewar painted the Ramayana, Mahabharata, Bhagavata Purana and Rasikpriya in flat, bright, crowded panels.
- **Bani Thani of Kishangarh** is the single most asked painting in the whole syllabus. She is the idealised Radha painted by **Nihal Chand** for the poet-king **Savant Singh** (who wrote under the name **Nagaridas**). Her features define the school: eyes curved like lotus petals, an arched brow, a pointed chin and a long neck. She is called the **"Mona Lisa of Rajasthan"** and has appeared on an Indian postage stamp.
- **Kota separated from Bundi in 1631** but kept painting — then developed its own obsession: the **royal hunt**. In Kota miniatures the thick green forest and the chase fill the whole page; queens are shown hunting tigers, which is rare in India.
- **Bundi paints nature first** — rain clouds, lotus ponds, peacocks and garden terraces; lovers come second. If the option shows lush greenery + water, think Bundi; if it shows the hunt, think Kota.
- **Pichhwai** paintings are not miniatures: they are **large cloth hangings** painted for the Shrinathji temple at **Nathdwara**, showing Krishna's festivals (Janmashtami, Annakut, Holi) around the central idol image.
- **Phad painting** is folk, not court. Centred at **Shahpura (Bhilwara district)**, the **Joshi painter-priests** paint long horizontal scrolls of the folk gods **Pabuji and Devnarayan** on cloth. The scroll is unrolled at night and sung by the Bhopa — painting, temple and theatre in one object. **Shrilal Joshi** of Shahpura is the best-known modern Phad artist.
- **Usta art (Bikaner)** — see the Handicrafts chapter — is gold painting on camel hide and other surfaces by the Usta community; it grew out of the same Bikaner court as the miniatures.

MEMORY HOOK: **"Kishangarh's eye"** — whenever a question describes lotus-shaped elongated eyes, the answer is Kishangarh + Nihal Chand + Bani Thani. And **Kota = shikar, Bundi = barish (rain/nature)** keeps the twin schools apart.

EXAM TRAP: Nisaruddin belongs to **Mewar (1605)**, not Marwar — the names sound alike. Similarly, **Nathdwara is Pichhwai, Shahpura is Phad** — both are cloth traditions tied to gods, but of different districts and deities.

PYQ PATTERN: "Bani Thani is associated with which school?" (Kishangarh), "Who painted the 1605 Ragamala?" (Nisaruddin), "Phad painting is famous at?" (Shahpura) — this chapter is a guaranteed cluster of one-liners.

Beyond the court: other painting traditions

- **Miniatures are painted on *wasli*** — a hand-made paper built by pasting several sheets together. Knowing the medium helps: gold and silver (*sona-chandi*) work marks the richer courts like Jaipur and Bikaner.
- **Kavad** — a portable wooden shrine with many painted doors, made at **Bassi (Chittorgarh)**; the Kavadiya Bhat opens the doors one by one while telling the story painted behind them — theatre, temple and picture-book in one box.
- **Mandana** — auspicious white-and-red-ochre paintings (khadia and geru) drawn by women on floors and courtyard walls for festivals and marriages; the **Meena** women of the east are its noted artists.
- **Sanjhi** — ritual floor/stencil art linked with Krishna worship in the Pushtimarg temples of Nathdwara and the Braj-facing east.
- **Devnarayan's Phad** deserves its dimensions: it is the **longest painted scroll tradition** of Rajasthan (about 30 feet in traditional panels), which is why the Saints chapter calls it the longest Phad — its *painter-singers* are Gujjar Bhopas, its instrument the Jantar.

MEMORY HOOK: Folk painting has three P's and a K — **Phad (Shahpura), Pichhwai (Nathdwara), Panel-wasli miniatures (courts), Kavad (Bassi)**.

4. Handicrafts of Rajasthan

The master table — craft × place

- Rajasthan's crafts are sold worldwide, but RAS asks only one thing: **which craft belongs to which place**. Learn this table cold.

Craft	Place	What it is / special note
Blue Pottery	Jaipur	Quartz-based pottery (no clay) with cobalt-blue designs of Persian origin; revived under Sawai Ram Singh II; maestro **Kripal Singh Shekhawat**; GI-tagged
Thewa Art	**Pratapgarh**	Fused **gold filigree work on coloured glass**; craft of the Rajsoni family, begun by **Nathu ji Soni**; GI-tagged
Meenakari	Jaipur	Enamel colours fired on gold and silver; artisans were brought from Lahore in Man Singh I's time; master **Kudrat Singh**
Kundan Jewellery	Jaipur	Setting precious stones in gold; Jaipur is India's kundan capital
Bandhej (Tie-and-Dye)	Jodhpur, Jaipur, Sikar	Knotted cloth dyed in dots — chunari and odhni patterns

Craft	Place	What it is / special note
Leheriya	Jaipur, Jodhpur	Wave-striped tie-dye, famous for turbans (safa) and odhnis
Sanganeri Print	Sanganer, Jaipur	Hand block printing, bright floral prints on white ground; GI-tagged
Bagru Print	Bagru, Jaipur district	Natural-dye block printing; **Dabu mud-resist** work; GI-tagged
Molela Terracotta	**Molela village, Rajsamand**	Hollow terracotta plaques of folk gods (Devnarayan, Nag ji) made by Kumhar potters; GI-tagged
Usta Art	Bikaner	Painting and **gold work on camel hide**, wood and marble by the Usta community; master **Hisamuddin Usta**
Kota Doria	Kota (Kaithun village)	Feather-light cotton-silk woven saree with square checks; GI-tagged
Mojari (Juti)	Jodhpur, Jaipur	Embroidered curled-toe leather footwear
Kathputli (Puppets)	Nagaur–Jaipur belt	Wooden string puppets worked by the Bhat community

How the crafts organised themselves

- Most crafts were hereditary work of specific communities, and a few of those community-pairs are asked directly: **Usta** artisans for Bikaner's gold painting were traditionally Muslims serving a Hindu court; the **Manihar** community works Jaipur's lac; the **Chhipa** block-printers gave Sanganer and Bagru their printed cloth, just as the Chhipa **Joshi** families of Shahpura paint the Phads; and the **Bhat** puppeteers carry the Kathputli tradition. Craft, caste and town survived together because royal courts and village jajmani both paid for the work.
- Two crafts illustrate the export story of modern Rajasthan: **Jaipur's gem and kundan trade** and **Jodhpur's furniture and handicraft exports** — but the exam weight stays on the old pairs in the table: craft × place × one distinguishing feature. If you can state all three for the twelve rows above, this chapter is fully scored.

Notes that clear the traps

- **Blue pottery uses no clay at all** — its body is quartz powder, glass and gum. This single inversion ("which craft is clay-free?") is a known RAS fact.
- **Thewa is NOT Jaipur work** — hands rush to Jaipur for every craft. Thewa = **Pratapgarh**; it is the only craft where **gold is worked onto glass**.
- **Sanganer vs Bagru** — both are Jaipur-area block prints: Sanganer = fine floral prints, usually on white/light cloth; Bagru = earthy colours from natural dyes with mud-resist (dabu) work.
- **Molela plaques are of gods, not pots** — the terracotta of Molela (near Nathdwara) is bought by devotees of Devnarayan and other folk deities, which is why it appears in culture questions rather than pottery ones.
- **Kota Doria weavers were originally brought from Mysore** by Maharao Kishore Singh; hence the cloth is also called **Masuria** (Mysore) malmal in old records.
- **GI tags** to remember as a group: Blue Pottery, Thewa, Molela terracotta, Kota Doria, Sanganeri print, Bagru print and Kathputli are among Rajasthan's GI-tagged crafts.

MEMORY HOOK: Build one line — **"Pratapgarh holds gold on glass (Thewa); Bikaner holds gold on camel (Usta); Jaipur holds colour on metal (Meenakari)."** Three gold-crafts, three cities, never confused again.

PYQ PATTERN: "Thewa art is related to —" (Pratapgarh), "Blue pottery is famous at —" (Jaipur), "Molela is known for —" (terracotta plaques). The craft × place table above answers nearly every question asked on this topic.

Second-line crafts worth a place-pair

Craft	Place	Note
Ajrakh & desert block prints	Barmer	Deep indigo-red geometric printing of the western desert belt
Bassi woodwork & Kavad	Bassi, Chittorgarh	Carved wooden toys, gangaur figures and the painted Kavad shrines
Jaipuri Razai	Jaipur	Feather-light printed quilts, famous across India
Gota Patti	Khandela (Sikar) and Jaipur	Gold-silver ribbon applique on bridal odhnis and poshaks
Pokhran pottery	Pokhran, Jaisalmer side	Red terracotta ware of the desert west
Jaipur lac work	Jaipur	Lac bangles and lacquered items of the Manihar community
Namda (felt)	Tonk	Woollen felt carpets and saddle cloths
Brass Nakashi	Udaipur, Jaipur side	Engraved brassware vessels

- **Jauhari and jadai clusters**: Jaipur's Johari Bazaar remains the trading heart of the gem-and-kundan economy, while the actual *setting* (jadai) is the older craft — examiners ask kundan with Jaipur, never with Jodhpur.

5. Folk Dances and Drama

Folk dances — the master table

Dance	Region / Community	Signature fact
Ghoomar	State-wide; Bhil origin, adopted by Rajput households	Women spin in wide ghaghras to songs like "Mhari Ghoom Chhe"; the signature dance of Rajasthan
Kalbeliya	**Sapera (snake-charmer) community**, Jaisalmer side	Inscribed in UNESCO's Intangible Heritage list in **2010**; swirling black dress imitates the cobra; exponent **Gulabo Sapera**
Chang	Shekhawati	Group dance of men with the chang (frame drum), performed around **Holi**

Dance	Region / Community	Signature fact
Gair	Mewar–Marwar **Bhil** belt	Men dance in a circle striking sticks together, at Holi; drummer stands in the centre
Kachchhi Ghodi	Shekhawati, Marwar	Dancers wear a **dummy horse** at the waist and enact mock sword battles to song
Bhavai	Mewar side	Performers balance **earthen pots stacked on the head**, even dancing on glass pieces or a sword's edge
Terah Taali	**Kamad community**, Pali side (Padarla village)	Seated devotees of Ramdevji strike **thirteen (terah) manjiras** tied to their bodies
Fire Dance (Agni Nritya)	**Jasnathi sect**, Katariasar (Bikaner)	Siddha ascetics dance on burning embers during night vigils
Kathputli	Bhat community	String-puppet dance-drama of legends and kings

- **Gavari** deserves a line of its own: it is the **Bhil** ritual dance-drama of Mewar, performed for about forty days after the rains in honour of the goddess Gavari (a form of Parvati), mixing dance, dialogue and the Shiva–Bhasmasur story. Examiners treat Gavari as **dance-drama**, not pure dance.

MEMORY HOOK: Count your way through the trick dances: **Terah Taali = 13 cymbals, Kalbeliya = UNESCO 2010, Bhavai = pots, Kachchhi Ghodi = dummy horse**. Four images answer four standard questions.

EXAM TRAP: Kalbeliya's UNESCO listing is under **Intangible Cultural Heritage (2010)** — the Hill Forts (2013) are on the **World Heritage (tangible)** list. Papers mix these two UNESCO facts deliberately.

Folk drama and theatre forms

Form	Region	What it is
Khyal	Whole state, several local types	The main folk opera of Rajasthan — sung dialogue, dance and story from epics and romances
— **Jaipuri Khyal**	Jaipur	Court-town style with developed female roles
— **Shekhawati (Chirawa) Khyal**	Chirawa, Shekhawati	Famous artist **Duliya Rana**; strong singing tradition
— **Kuchamani Khyal**	Kuchaman, Nagaur side	Founded by **Lachhi Ram**, whose written plays made it the most literary khyal
— **Turra-Kalangi Khyal**	Mewar	Two troupes debate in song; created by Shah Ali and Tukangir
— **Alibakshi Khyal**	Alwar (Mewat)	Linked to Munshi **Alibaksh**
Rammat	Bikaner–Jaisalmer	Open-air sung plays on epics and saints, performed at Holi and in Sawan; poets called *Tej Kavi* was its Jaisalmer name

Form	Region	What it is
Phad Vachan	Shahpura belt	The Bhopa **sings the painted Phad scroll** of Pabuji or Devnarayan at night with the Ravanhatta
Tamasha	Jaipur	Open-air theatre with Mughal-court influence; patronised under Sawai Pratap Singh; master **Banshidhar Bhatt**
Bhavai theatre	Mewar–Gujarat border	Improvised satirical folk plays (vesha) with sharp social comment
Swang	Bharatpur–Alwar (Mewat)	One actor imitates many characters with costume changes
Nautanki	Eastern Rajasthan	UP-style musical theatre popular in the Bharatpur–Dholpur belt

- Notice the geography: **Khyal** covers the whole state in dialect flavours, **Rammat** is the desert west, **Swang/Nautanki** the Mewat-Braj east, and **Tamasha** the Jaipur court. If a question asks "which folk theatre is from Bikaner–Jaisalmer", the answer is **Rammat**, not Khyal.

PYQ PATTERN: Khyal types are a regular match-the-pair: **Chirawa = Shekhawati, Kuchamani = Lachhi Ram, Turra-Kalangi = Mewar debate**. Learn them as fixed pairs.

More regional dances

Dance	Region / Community	Note
Dhol Dance	Jalore	Professional drum dance in which dancers play huge dhols while dancing
Loor	Hadauti (Kota–Bundi)	Graceful women's dance of the Holi season
Neja	Bhil–Meena belt of Mewar	Dancers balance and climb around a planted pole (neja) in festival play
Valar	Garasia tribe (Sirohi–Udaipur hills)	Slow, graceful couple dance of the Garasia community, without instruments
Kood	Garasia tribe	Harvest-time group dance
Sahariya dance	Sahariya tribe (Baran)	The principal dance of Rajasthan's only PVTG tribe, seen at the Sitabari fair
Panihari	Desert belt	Dance form of the water-fetching song, pots balanced in rhythm

- The tribal belt has its own dance map — **Bhil: Gair, Gavari, Neja; Garasia: Valar, Kood; Sahariya: their Sitabari dances**. RAS likes to ask "which dance belongs to which tribe", and these three sets close that question.

6. Music and Instruments

Classical links — Rajasthan's gharanas

- **Jaipur–Atrauli gharana** — founded by **Ustad Alladiya Khan** (born at Uniara, in present Tonk district). It is a khayal gharana famous for complex, rare ragas; its greatest name is **Kesarbai Kerkar**.
- **Mewati gharana** — named after the Mewat region; its world-famous exponent is **Pandit Jasraj**.
- **Dhrupad and the Dagars** — the **Dagar family** of dhrupad singers was attached to the Jaipur and Udaipur courts for generations; Ustad **Ziauddin Dagar** and the Dagar brothers kept Rajasthan inside the oldest surviving classical singing style.
- **Maand** — Rajasthan's own semi-classical court singing: a folk melody polished for royal darbars. **Allah Jilai Bai of Bikaner** (Padma Shri) is its immortal voice; her **"Kesariya Balam Aao Ni Padharo Mhare Des"** is the best-known Rajasthani song in India.

Folk singing communities and songs

- **Manganiyars** — hereditary Muslim folk musicians of the **Jaisalmer–Barmer** desert, singing for Rajput patrons for centuries. Their lead instrument is the **Kamaycha**; masters like **Sakar Khan** (Kamaycha) took the tradition to world stages.
- **Langas** — hereditary singers of the **Jaisalmer–Jodhpur–Pali** belt, also serving Rajput patrons; their lead instrument is the **Sindhi Sarangi** (master: **Lakha Khan**).
- **Pabuji ke Pavade** — short heroic ballads of Pabuji sung by **Nayak bhopas**, distinct from the full night-long Phad singing.
- Famous folk songs and their occasions:

- **Panihari** — sung by women going to fetch water; the melody of desert labour. - **Gorband** — song in praise of the ornamented camel ("Gorband Nakhralo"). - **Kurjan** — the beloved (a bride) asks the demoiselle crane (kurjan) to carry her message home. - **Bichhudo** — Marwar's song of the separated bride. - **Teej and Holi songs** — seasonal songs of the Shravan swing festival and spring; the Jaipur Teej procession moves to this music. - **Indoni** — the fast Kalbeliya dance song.

EXAM TRAP: **Manganiyar ≠ Langa** — papers swap their instruments. Fix it: **Manganiyar → Kamaycha; Langa → Sindhi Sarangi**. Both are hereditary Muslim musician communities of the western desert serving Hindu patrons — that shared frame is exactly why examiners pair them.

Instruments — the four-fold table

- Indian instruments are classed in four families: **Tat** (string), **Sushir** (wind), **Avanaddha** (skin/membrane percussion) and **Ghana** (solid idiophones struck together). RAS asks instruments with their family.

Instrument	Family	Who plays it / special fact
Ravanhatta	String (bowed)	The **Bhopa's fiddle for Pabuji's Phad**; body of half a coconut shell
Kamaycha	String (bowed)	Huge round resonator; lead instrument of the **Manganiyars**
Sarangi	String (bowed)	Closest instrument to the human voice; Langa's **Sindhi Sarangi** is its folk form
Bhapang	String (single string)	Rare instrument of **Mewat (Alwar)**; made famous by **Jahur Khan Mewati**

Instrument	Family	Who plays it / special fact
Ektara	String (single string)	The wandering saint-singer's drone instrument
Algoza	Wind	**Double flute** — two pipes played together, one giving the drone; Langa and Gurjar players
Pungi (Been)	Wind	The snake-charmer's gourd pipe of the **Kalbeliya** performance
Shehnai	Wind	Auspicious double-reed pipe of weddings and temples
Mashak	Wind	Rajasthan's own **bagpipe**, heard in Mewar folk bands
Nagada	Membrane (Avanaddha)	Great kettle-drums of forts and temples, played in pairs with sticks
Chang	Membrane	Large frame drum of the Shekhawati **Holi** dance
Dholak / Mandar	Membrane	The everyday drums of village song and dance
Khartal	Ghana (solid)	Two pairs of wooden blocks with bells, clicked masterfully by Manganiyar singers
Morchang	Ghana (mouth)	Small iron Jew's harp held to the teeth; a Langa-Kalbeliya favourite
Manjira	Ghana	Small hand cymbals — thirteen of them make the **Terah Taali** dance

MEMORY HOOK: The **Ravanhatta always means Pabuji** — instrument, god and singer come as one fixed triple (Ravanhatta + Phad + Bhopa). And the only double-pipe wind instrument is the **Algoza**.

PYQ PATTERN: "Kamaycha is associated with which community?" (Manganiyar), "Bhapang is from which region?" (Mewat), "Algoza is what type of instrument?" (wind/double flute) — the table covers all three.

More singer communities and instruments

- **Dhadhi** — the hereditary court bards who sang war-songs (veer-geet) before Rajput armies; with the Charans they formed the singing memory of the kingdoms.
- **Kamad singers** — devotees of Ramdevji; their night bhajans are sung to the **Tandoora** (a four-string drone lute), and their women perform Terah Taali.
- **Jantar** — the veena-like string instrument played only by the **Gujjar Bhopas of Devnarayan** while singing his Phad; like the Ravanhatta, it is a "one-god instrument".
- **Deru** — a small hourglass drum tied to folk bhajan singing.
- **Meera's bhajans** belong to every sect and none: sung in temples, satsangs and courtyards alike, they are the devotional music bridge between the classical and folk chapters of this book.

MEMORY HOOK: One-god instruments: **Ravanhatta = Pabuji, Jantar = Devnarayan, Tandoora = Ramdevji bhajans, Been = Kalbeliya's snake world**. These four pairs are asked as a set.

7. Language, Dialects and Literature

The dialects — one state, many tongues

- **Rajasthani** is the collective name of the dialects spoken across the state. Linguist **Grierson** classified them in his *Linguistic Survey of India*, and the Italian scholar **L. P. Tessitori** did pioneering work on Rajasthani literature and its old bardic form, Dingal.
- The big fact for the exam: **Rajasthani is recognised by the Sahitya Akademi as an independent literary language, but it is NOT in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution** — the long-standing demand to include it there is a regular RAS question.

Dialect	Region	Note
Marwari	Jodhpur, Bikaner, Nagaur, Pali, Barmer, Jaisalmer	The **largest and most widespread** dialect; base of the literary Dingal
Mewari	Udaipur, Rajsamand, Chittorgarh, Bhilwara	Dialect of Mewar; close to Marwari in the west
Dhundhari	Jaipur, Dausa, Tonk, Sawai Madhopur side	Dialect of the Dhundhar (Jaipur) state; influenced by Braj towards the east
Hadoti	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar	Dialect of the Hada Chauhan country; touched by Malvi in the south-east
Mewati	Alwar, Bharatpur (Mewat)	Close to **Braj**; language of the Meo community
Ahirwati	Behror–Neemrana–Mundawar (Alwar side)	Dialect of the Ahir belt, between Mewati and Haryanvi
Vagdi	Dungarpur, Banswara (Vagad)	Tribal Bhil dialect, **influenced by Gujarati**
Bagri	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh	Northern dialect blending into Haryanvi and Punjabi
Shekhawati	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Churu	Usually counted within the Marwari group
Malvi	Jhalawar's southern fringe	Malwa's dialect spilling into Rajasthan's south-east
Rangri	Rajput families of the Malwa border	A spoken mix of Marwari and Malvi

MEMORY HOOK: The dialect map follows the old kingdoms — **Marwar speaks Marwari, Mewar Mewari, Dhundhar Dhundhari, Hadoti the Hada country**. Name the kingdom and you have named the dialect.

Dingal, Pingal and the Charans

- **Dingal** — the old literary form of Marwari used by **Charan** bards for heroic poetry (vir-ras): praise-poems, war ballads and genealogies sung in royal courts.
- **Pingal** — the literary form of the east, built on **Braj**, used for devotional and romantic verse.
- The **Charans** were not mere singers: they were court historians and guarantors of honour. Their chronicles are called **Khyats**:

- **Nainsi ri Khyat** — by **Muhnot Nainsi** (17th century, Marwar), the great prose history of Marwar's clans; Nainsi is often called the **Abul Fazl of Rajasthan**. - **Bankidas ri Khyat** — by Charan **Bankidas** of Jodhpur. - **Vansh Bhaskar** — the epic history of Bundi by **Suryamal Misran**, Bundi's court poet.

- **Kesari Singh Barhath**, a Charan poet, wrote the famous **"Chetawani ra Chungtiya"** — thirteen couplets warning Maharana Fateh Singh of Mewar not to bow before the British at the 1903 Delhi Durbar.

Major works and authors

Work	Author	Note
Prithviraj Raso	**Chand Bardai**	Epic of Prithviraj Chauhan III; Chand Bardai was his court poet and friend
Veli Krisan Rukmani Ri	**Prithviraj Rathore** ("Peethal")	Bikaner prince-poet at Akbar's court; the finest Dingal love poem of Krishna–Rukmini
Dhola–Maru ra Doha	Traditional (dohas linked to the poet **Kallol**)	The classic folk love ballad — Dhola of Narwar and Maru of Pugal
Nainsi ri Khyat	Muhnot Nainsi	Prose chronicle of Marwar
Vansh Bhaskar	Suryamal Misran	Verse history of Bundi and the Hadas

- **Vijay Singh Pathik** — though born in UP, he made Rajasthan his field: he led the **Bijolia peasant movement**, founded the **Rajasthan Seva Sangh (1919)** and spread nationalism through papers like *Rajasthan Kesari* — the bridge between folk literature and modern journalism.
- Modern Rajasthani writing: **Kanhaiyalal Sethia** (poet of **"Dharti Dhora Ri"**, the anthem-like poem of the desert land), **Vijaydan Detha "Bijji"** (collector-writer of folk tales, *Batan ri Phulwari*; Padma Shri) and **Komal Kothari** (folklorist who, with Detha, founded the **Rupayan Sansthan at Borunda, Jodhpur** to record folk music and tales).

Folk literature forms

- **Lok Katha** — the folk tale told by grandmothers and travelling storytellers.
- **Bat** — the Charan's sharp, witty narrative anecdote (Vijaydan Detha's collection is literally called *Batan ri Phulwari* — "a garden of bats").
- **Phad** — the painted scroll that is itself a text, sung by the Bhopa.
- **Pavada** — the short heroic ballad (Pabuji ke Pavade).
- **Lok Geet** — folk songs of water, weddings, separation and seasons (Panihari, Gorband, Kurjan).

PYQ PATTERN: "Rajasthani is included in which Schedule?" — the trap answer is that it is **in NO Schedule**; it only has Sahitya Akademi recognition. And "Prithviraj Raso was written by — Chand Bardai" is the oldest chestnut of this chapter.

The genres of old Rajasthani writing

- **Raso** — the long heroic epic in verse (Prithviraj Raso, Hammir Raso).
- **Veli** — a Dingal poem of high literary polish, often devotional (Veli Krisan Rukmani Ri).
- **Khyat** — the Charan's prose chronicle of a dynasty and its clans (Nainsi, Bankidas).

- **Vigat** — a detailed prose record of villages, revenue and customs; Nainsi's *Marwar ra Pargana ri Vigat* is the model.
- **Vachanika** — rhythmic prose narration of a hero's deed.
- **Davavait** — verses narrating a warrior's life and battles, a Bikaner-side form.
- **Jhoolna and Duha** — short metres used for love and heroic fragments (Dhola–Maru is built of duhas).

EXAM TRAP: Khyat is prose, Raso is verse — papers offer "Nainsi ri Khyat is an epic poem" as a false statement. Nainsi also wrote the *Vigat*, making him the ancestor of Rajasthan's gazetteer tradition, not just its storytelling.

8. Saints, Sects and Folk Deities

The bhakti saints and their sects

- Rajasthan's religious life was shaped by wandering saints who preached in the people's language against caste and empty ritual. RAS asks each saint with **one place and one number or one institution** — fix those anchors.

Saint / Sect	Centre / Seat	Anchor fact
Dadu Dayal — Dadu Panth	**Naraina** (Jaipur district)	Born in Ahmedabad (1544), settled at Naraina; his verses are the *Dadu Vani*; panth remembered for its **52 disciple-pillars (stambh)**; the armed **Naga branch** was raised by Sundardas
Meera Bai	Born **Kudki** (Pali); married into Mewar	Krishna-devotee; wife of Bhojraj, son of Rana Sanga; tradition makes **Raidas her guru**; her beloved is Giridhar Gopal
Raidas (Ravidas)	Associated with Chittorgarh in Rajasthan tradition	Cobbler-saint of the bhakti movement; a Raidas chhatri stands at Chittorgarh
Jambho Ji — Bishnoi sect	**Samrathal Dhora** (Bikaner side); born Pipasar (Nagaur)	Sect founded **1485**; **29 rules** (bish = 20 + noi = 9) protecting trees and animals; samadhi and great fair at **Mukam**
Jasnath Ji — Jasnathi sect	**Katariasar** (Bikaner)	Siddha saint; his followers perform the **fire dance**; 36 rules of the sect
Ramcharan Ji — Ramsnehi sect	**Shahpura** (Bhilwara)	Born at Soda (Tonk); chief seat Shahpura with branches at Ren, Kherapa and Singhthal; *Anbhai Vani* is his work; Shahpura's Phooldol fair is famous
Laldas — Laldasi sect	**Nagla** (Alwar side)	The great saint of **Mewat**; preached Hindu–Muslim unity in the Alwar–Bharatpur belt
Charandas — Charandasi sect	Born Dehra (Alwar); main centre Delhi	His women disciples **Sahjo Bai** (*Sahaj Prakash*) and **Daya Bai** became famous saints themselves

Saint / Sect	Centre / Seat	Anchor fact
Nimbarka sect	**Salemabad** (Ajmer district)	The sect's chief seat (peeth) in Rajasthan
Niranjani sect	**Didwana** (Nagaur)	Founded by Sant **Haridas Niranjani**
Vallabh sect (Pushtimarg)	**Nathdwara**	Centres at Nathdwara, Kota and Kaman (Bharatpur) — worship of child Krishna
Ramanandi sect	**Galta** (Jaipur)	Peeth established by **Krishnadas Payahari** in the Galta valley
Mavji — Nishkalank sect	**Sabla** (Dungarpur)	Saint of the Vagad Bhils, worshipped as an incarnation; linked with the Beneshwar tradition

- **The Khejarli sacrifice (1730)** belongs to this chapter: at village **Khejarli (Jodhpur)**, **Amrita Devi Bishnoi** and **363 Bishnois** hugged the khejri trees and were killed rather than let Maharaja Abhay Singh's men cut them. It is the world's most famous tree-protection martyrdom and flows directly from Jambho Ji's 29 rules.

MEMORY HOOK: Numbers lock the sects in: **Bishnoi = 29 rules, 1485, Samrathal; Dadu = Naraina + 52 pillars; Ramsnehi = Shahpura**. If an option gives a sect with a number, match the number first.

EXAM TRAP: Jambho Ji founded the Bishnoi sect at Samrathal Dhora, but his samadhi and fair are at Mukam — founding place and fair place are different answers. Also, **Salemabad is Nimbarka; Galta is Ramanandi** — the two peeths are swapped in options.

Folk deities (Lok Devta) — the heroes who became gods

- Rajasthan's folk gods were mostly **Rajput and Jat heroes** who died protecting cows, women or the village, and are now worshipped by all castes. Five of them — **Pabuji, Ramdevji, Gogaji, Harbhuji and Mehaji** — are honoured together as the **Panch Pir of Marwar**.

Folk deity	Community / Region	Symbol / Vehicle	Main place & fair
Ramdevji	All castes; Runicha, Jaisalmer side	Footprints (**pagliya**) worshipped; rides the **camel** in folk tradition; flag called *Neja*	Samadhi and great fair at **Ramdevra (Runicha)** in Bhadrapada; **Terah Taali** dance by Kamad women
Pabuji	Charans and herders of Marwar	Black mare **Kesar Kalami**; credited with bringing the **first camel to Marwar**	Died saving the cattle of Deval Charan; his **Phad** is sung with the Ravanhatta; main seat **Kolu** (Jodhpur side)
Gogaji	Snake deity, Hindu and Muslim ("Jahar Pir")	Serpent; blue mare	Born **Dadrewa (Churu)**; samadhi and fair at **Gogamedi (Hanumangarh)** on Goga Navami; worshipped under the khejri tree

Folk deity	Community / Region	Symbol / Vehicle	Main place & fair
Tejaji	Jat hero; snakebite healer	Mare **Lilan**	Born **Kharnal (Nagaur)**; kept his word to the serpent and let it bite his tongue at Sursura; great fair at **Parbatsar** on Teja Dashmi
Devnarayan	**Gujjar** deity	Serpent (Basak Nag)	Main temple **Asind (Bhilwara)**; his is the **longest Phad** of Rajasthan, sung by Gujjar bhopas with the Jantar
Mallinath Ji	Marwar (Rathore saint-ruler)	Horse	Seat and famous cattle fair at **Tilwara** on the Luni (Balotra side)
Harbhuji	Sankhla Rajput of Bhundel (Nagaur)	The **jackal (siyar)**	Temple at **Bengti** (Phalodi side); a Pir among the Panch Pir
Mehaji Mangaliya	Mangaliya Rajput	Horse	Temple at **Bapini** (Jodhpur side); completes the Panch Pir of Marwar

- Among folk **goddesses**, fix two for cross-reference: **Karni Mata of Deshnok** (temple chapter) became the clan goddess of Bikaner's Rathores, and **Jeen Mata (Sikar)** is the Chauhan clan goddess worshipped near Rewasa.

MEMORY HOOK: Each devta has ONE object: **Pabuji–mare Kesar Kalami, Tejaji–mare Lilan, Gogaji–snake, Devnarayan–longest Phad, Ramdevji–pagliya + Terah Taali**. Ask "whose mare?" and you have the chapter.

PYQ PATTERN: The **Panch Pir** list and the **longest Phad = Devnarayan** are asked again and again. Note the fine point: Pabuji's Phad is the most *famous*, Devnarayan's is the *longest*.

Two courtier-saints and the goddesses

- **Sant Pipa Ji** — a king of **Gagron** who gave up his throne to become a disciple of Ramananda; the tailor (darzi) community honours him as its patron saint, and a cave at Gagron still bears his name.
- **Sant Dhanna Ji** — a **Jat** farmer-saint of **Dhuan village (Tonk)**, also counted among Ramananda's disciples; his life says the Lord himself came to plough his field.
- **Sant Rajjab** — Dadu Dayal's Muslim disciple, who stayed a lifelong celibate and kept the master's verses alive; a standing symbol of the Dadu Panth's open door.

Folk goddess	Place	Note
Jeen Mata	Near Rewasa, Sikar	Clan goddess of the Chauhans; ancient temple in the Aravalli folds
Shakambhari Devi	Sambhar, Jaipur side	Goddess of the salt-lake town; Chauhan kuldevi tradition
Sheetla Mata	Chaksu, Jaipur side	Healing goddess of Basoda (Sheetlashtami)

Folk goddess	Place	Note
Aai Mata	Bilara, Jodhpur side	Goddess of the Sirvi community; her temple lamp is said to drip *kesar* (saffron)
Kaila Devi	Karauli	Royal goddess of the Karauli Yaduvanshis; Lakhi fair in Chaitra
Rani Sati	Jhunjhunu	Centre of the Sati-mata tradition of Shekhawati's merchant families

MEMORY HOOK: Saints cut across caste on purpose in RAS questions — **Raidas (cobbler), Pipa (a king who renounced), Dhanna (Jat farmer), Rajjab (a Muslim in Dadu's Hindu-majority panth)**. If an option claims bhakti was caste-bound, it is false.

9. Fairs, Festivals, Customs, Attire and Ornaments

The great fairs — master table

Fair	Place	Time / Occasion	Special fact
Pushkar Fair	Pushkar, Ajmer	**Kartik Purnima**	World's famous **camel and cattle fair** beside the sacred lake and Brahma temple
Nagaur Cattle Fair	Nagaur	January–February (Magh)	Among India's largest livestock fairs, famous for bullocks and the **Mirchi Bazaar** (chilli market)
Beneshwar Fair	Beneshwar, Dungarpur	**Magh Purnima**	**"Kumbh of the tribals"** at the sangam of the **Som, Mahi and Jakham** rivers
Ramdevra Fair	Ramdevra, Jaisalmer side	Bhadrapada	Pilgrims (many walking barefoot) at Ramdevji's samadhi
Tejaji Fair	Parbatsar, Nagaur	**Teja Dashmi** (Bhadrapada)	Cattle fair with Tejaji worship for snakebite protection
Kaila Devi Fair	Kaila Devi, Karauli	Chaitra	Called the **Lakhi fair** for its lakhs of devotees
Shri Mahavirji Fair	Mahavirji, Karauli	Chaitra	Great Jain fair of the 24th Tirthankara; rath yatra of the Digambar tradition
Urs of Ajmer	Dargah of Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti, Ajmer	Rajab (Islamic month)	India's most famous Urs; devotees of all faiths
Kolayat Fair	Kolayat, Bikaner	Kartik Purnima	Bathing fair at Kapil Muni's sacred lake
Tilwara Cattle Fair	Tilwara (Luni bank)	Chaitra	Mallinath Ji's fair, among the oldest cattle fairs

Fair	Place	Time / Occasion	Special fact
Desert Festival	Jaisalmer	January–February	Camel races, folk dance, turban-tying and moustache contests in the Sam dunes
Marwar Festival	Jodhpur	Ashwin (Sharad Purnima)	Celebrates the heroes and folk music of Marwar
Mewar Festival	Udaipur	Spring (with Gangaur)	Welcomes spring; images of Isar–Gangaur are carried to Lake Pichola

EXAM TRAP: Pushkar and Kolayat are both Kartik Purnima fairs — Pushkar = camel fair + Ajmer; Kolayat = Kapil Muni + Bikaner. And **Beneshwar = Som + Mahi + Jakham** (three rivers); if an option says Mahi + Som only, it is incomplete, not wrong in pairing — RAS asks the full triveni.

Festivals of the social calendar

- **Gangaur** — the biggest women's festival, for **Gauri (Parvati)**: eighteen days from the day after Holi in **Chaitra**. Jaipur's and Udaipur's Gangaur processions are famous; at Udaipur the festival merges with the **Mewar Festival** and the images are taken to **Gangaur Ghat** on Pichola.
- **Teej** — **Hariyali Teej** in Shravan, when Jaipur takes out the procession of Teej Mata from the City Palace; women wear green and leheriya, and swing songs fill the month.
- **Kajli Teej** — the trap version of Teej: celebrated at **Bundi** a fortnight later, on **Bhadrapada Krishna Tritiya**. Same goddess-mood, different date and city.
- **Akha Teej (Akshaya Tritiya)** — Vaishakh Shukla Tritiya, the most auspicious marriage day of the year in village Rajasthan.
- **Dhinga Gavar** — Jodhpur's unique festival in which married women, dressed and armed like men, roam at night teasing onlookers — a festival found only in Marwar.
- **Kota Dussehra** — Kota's Dussehra fair is the grandest in the state, running for weeks with a huge mela.
- **Bhagoriya** — the Bhil harvest-and-love festival of the Vagad–Hadauti tribal belt around Holi, when young people choose partners at the haat fair.

Johar, saka and the customs of life

- **Saka** — when defeat was certain, the men of a fort put on **kesariya (saffron)** and rode out to die fighting; simultaneously the women performed **Johar (Jauhar)** — collective self-immolation so as not to fall into enemy hands. Chittorgarh's **three sakas (1303, 1535, 1568)** are the defining examples; Jaisalmer's **"ardh saka" (half-saka, 1550)** is remembered because events moved too fast for the full rite.
- **Birth customs** — **Jalwa pujan** (worship of the well/kuan by the new mother), **Dasothan** (the tenth-day ceremony).
- **Marriage customs** — **Nikasi** (the groom's procession setting out), **Toran marna** (the groom touching the door toran with his sword), **Pahrawani** and the **Mayra/Bhaat** (gifts brought by the bride's maternal uncle).
- **Death customs** — **Mausar**, the death feast held on the twelfth day, and **Nukta**, the condolence gathering; the **pag-bandh** ceremony passes the turban — and headship of the family — to the heir.

Dress of Rajasthan

- **Men** — **dhoti** with **angarkha** (the fitted upper garment) and the **pagh/safa (turban)**, which announces region and occasion: Jodhpuri and Jaipuri safas have their own tying styles, and **kesariya** is the colour of festivity and battle.
- **Women** — **ghaghra** with **kurti-kanchali** (bodice) and the **odhni/lugra** over the head: **bandhej** and **leheriya** odhnis for festivals, the yellow **pomcha** linked with motherhood and auspicious rites, and cotton lugras for daily wear in the desert belt.

Ornaments — worn where?

Ornament	Worn where / by whom	Note
Rakhdi	Head — on the forehead at the hair parting	Round gold ornament, the mark of a married woman
Borla	Head — hanging on the forehead	Bell/ball-shaped ornament paired with the rakhdi
Sheeshphool	Head — along the hair parting	Chain ornament worn with the borla
Nath	Nose	Large ring, often with a chain to the ear
Aad	Neck	Broad **gold choker** of Marwar brides, studded with uncut stones
Hansli	Neck	Rigid silver collar of rural women
Timaniya	Neck	Necklace of gold beads/pebbles
Bajuband	Upper arm	Armlet of gold or silver
Chooda	Wrist	Set of lac or ivory bangles; Jaipur's lac bangles are famous
Hathphool	Back of the hand	Rings joined by chains to a bracelet
Kandora	Waist	Silver waist-belt (kamarband)
Kada	Ankle	Heavy silver anklet worn by rural and tribal women
Payal	Ankle	The tinkling silver anklet
Bichhiya	Toe	Toe ring — the sign of a married woman, never worn on the hands

MEMORY HOOK: Body order answers the ornament table — **head (Rakhdi, Borla), neck (Aad), arm (Bajuband), ankle (Kada, Payal), toe (Bichhiya)**. Walk down the body and the pairs fix themselves.

PYQ PATTERN: End-of-syllabus chapters are pure profit in RAS: **Beneshwar = tribal Kumbh, Kajli Teej = Bundi, Aad = neck, Jaisalmer = Desert Festival + ardh saka**. Revise this chapter last — it is the fastest to score from.

Festival extras and the turban

- **Sheetlashtami (Basoda)** — in Chaitra, families eat food cooked the previous day and worship Sheetla Mata for protection from disease; the Chaksu temple (Jaipur side) draws the big fair.
- **Hariyali Amavasya** — the monsoon fair-day of Udaipur, when the city gathers around its lakes at the height of the rains.

- **Annakut at Nathdwara** — the Govardhan festival after Diwali, when Shrinathji is offered a mountain of food; the town's Pichhwai painters prepare special hangings for it.
- **Safa styles worth naming** — turban-tying is itself an art with contest categories at fairs: the **Jodhpuri safa** (long cloth, single tail), the **Jaipuri pagh**, and the grand **Mewari pagh** of Udaipur are recognised regional styles; the **flame-coloured leheriya safa** is worn for festivity. A man's safa announced his home region before he spoke a word.
- Two more hand ornaments complete the body-map: **Arsi**, the thumb ring with a small mirror, and **Gokhru**, the broad spiked-looking bracelet of rural women.

EXAM TRAP: Gangaur lasts eighteen days (from the day after Holi) — papers offer 16 and 18 as close options; the traditional count is 18. And remember the festival twin: **Teej (Jaipur, Shravan) vs Kajli Teej (Bundi, Bhadrapada)** — same mood, different month, different city.

StuDy